scope as monopolies started transferring factories to other countries. Alliances and inter-business groups, whose historical roots are diversified,[8] developed further with governmental agreements served by international institutions that guarantee capitalist property. This process was not without tensions because large areas of the planet, even though under Western dominion, resisted. It is important to remember that the great majority of people in the world still lived in rural areas and reproduced – and defended – pre-capitalist modes of existence.

It is crucial to emphasise that capitalist social relations do not only respond to pressures coming from powerful countries but go through all social formations. Derived out of varied historical combinations, subordinate (or peripheral) countries' dominant classes produce many tense pressures toward transforming existing social relations. Segments of the subaltern classes respect the thrust of 'development', which is generally thought to be the same as 'progress'. Many times social demands are confounded – even if confusedly – with support for the expansion of capitalist social relations. The dominant international dynamic influences the very formation of national social classes. Facilitated by powerful media, the creation of spaces of capitalist-type production and consumption produces acceleration as well as delay due to historical conditions. Added to this are the complex relationships between different fractions of the dominant and subordinate classes, which are already complicated by permanent external stresses (pressures and obstacles).

The integration of these countries into the multinational industrial and commercial network not only derives from external imposition but also depends upon the active behaviour of local bourgeoisies and their capacity for accumulation, organisation and control over the state.[9] They achieve a dynamic membership in capital-imperialism as well as in its institutional (through legal adjustments), social and political defence, as we shall see later. This is the second characteristic we highlight: the double – internal and external – incorporation of subordinate countries into capital-imperialism, in a process which involves not only external imposition but also the consolidation of states and local bourgeoisies. This feature requires analysis of the unequal and combined forms that constitute capitalist expansion, surely as diverse as the various countries involved. Meanwhile it is possible to state that, within the BRICS countries, there has occurred a deep and important expansion of capitalist social relations, due as much to the existence of processes of industrialisation as to the transformation of the lives of large population sectors.

The shape of multinationalisation (of enterprises and capitals) was given an enormous impetus by China's industrialisation and later the final Soviet crisis.